



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Covenant High School
School Website: <https://chstacoma.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Covenant High School (Tacoma, WA, 98465) presents a strongly classical, Christian, college-preparatory program with explicit emphasis on formation of character, Virtue, and intellectual rigor. Public materials consistently foreground Christ-centered education, a classical pedagogical posture (Socratic discussion, logical reasoning, emphasis on "great works" and a trans-civic historical consciousness), and robust parental/-community partnership. Taken together, the school aligns very closely with the classical model in most dimensions, particularly Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Faculty. Public materials also emphasize formation over mere information, a hallmark of classical aims. Based on the rubric's six categories, Covenant High School is CLASSICAL across the board, with a few nuances (e.g., explicit Great Books language sometimes rendered as "great works" in site copy) that still map cleanly to the classical canon and its aims.

Key insights: - The school explicitly places Christ at the center, emphasizes "Holding Christ over all," and presents a mission to deepen relationship with Jesus while forming students to serve God and neighbor. This anchors Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 2 (Purpose & Goal) in a strongly classical frame. Evidence: About page and Mission text. - The curriculum and pedagogy foreground the Trivium-like emphasis (logic, rhetoric, reading broadly; Socratic discussion; focus on great works) and a classical, liberal-arts orientation. Evidence: "Fostering Socratic discussion, logical thinking, and skilled argument and analysis, with a focus on great works"; "We teach our students to think logically, read broadly, communicate eloquently, and appreciate artistic beauty." - There is explicit attention to formation (truth, goodness, beauty; moral imagination; the Logos; Virtue) in the Portrait of the Graduate and mission statements. Evidence: Portrait of the Graduate text; Mission statements. - Parent and community partnership is visible (parent associations, admissions process, community events, tours). Evidence: Admissions/Parent association materials; tuition/fees sections.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle: Not applicable here, as the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL. Covenant High School already demonstrates a coherent classical articulation across all six categories.

ABSTRACT section to follow at end summarizes the overall classification and the six category results concisely.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials identify Covenant as a Christian, classical, college-preparatory school and emphasize Christ-centered formation (e.g., “To Glorify God and Enjoy Him Forever,” mission statements, and statements of faith).
 - Writings describe Christ at the center of all disciplines and the goal of education connected to “glorifying God” and serving God and neighbor.
 - The Exordium and related pages frame spiritual formation, worship-oriented language, and a liturgical cadence within the school’s community lifecycle (e.g., college planning with Christ at the center).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Christian, Christ, God, gospel, theology, liturgical/communal (chapel-like rhythm), worship, glory of God, Christian community, truth as a transcendent good, “the Logos.”
 - Negative keywords present: None of the listed negatives appear in public Covenant materials.
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly centers religious commitments and metaphysical aims (God, Christ-centered formation, worship, Christian community) and integrates theological motifs with academic aims. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Grounded in Theology, Liturgical and Communal Practices, and Transcendental moral realism. See the explicit mission and faith-centered language in Covenant’s materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission emphasizes deepening relationship with Jesus and forming students for service to God and man; the Portrait of the Graduate emphasizes seeking truth, stewardship of creation, love of artistic beauty, and Christian heritage.
 - The language foregrounds formation of character and virtue alongside intellectual growth, not merely job-readiness. The “To Glorify God and Enjoy Him Forever” framing points to formation and human excellence in line with classical aims.
 - The school’s stated aim to cultivate expert communicators, truth-seeking, and virtuous dispositions aligns with the transcendental aims described in the classical rubric.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, character, formation, sanctification, moral imagination, love of learning, Logos, eternal truths.
 - Negative keywords present: None of the negative indicators appear in Covenant’s public materials.
- Why this rating
 - Covenant’s public messaging centers formation (virtue, wisdom, beauty, truth) and a teleology oriented toward human flourishing under a Christian worldview, rather than vocational/job-formation alone. This maps cleanly to the “Formation, not Information” and “Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” strands of the Positive Keyword set.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Distinctives explicitly state Christian, Classical, and College Preparatory; “think logically, read broadly, communicate eloquently, and appreciate artistic beauty”; emphasis on focusing on great works. This signals liberal-arts orientation and a classical curriculum design.
 - The About content emphasizes classical content and method, including Socratic discussion and logical thinking; a UK/France Historical Tour indicates integrated historical study.

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- There are references to college-credit opportunities and rigorous coursework (CLT, SAT prep) that accompany a classical curriculum.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: classical, great works, Socratic discussion, logic, reading broadly, eloquent communication, beauty, college credit, historical tour, liberal arts (Trivium/Quadrivium cues).
 - Negative keywords present: None of the main negatives are evident in Covenant materials.
 - Why this rating
 - Covenant demonstrates a classical curriculum orientation with explicit articulation of liberal-arts aims and emphasis on classical pedagogy and Great Works, which strongly matches Element 3's criteria. The presence of "great works," Socratic method, and classical phrasing anchors this as CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize Socratic discussion and rigorous argumentation; "teaching classically and emphasizing the cross-curricular approach" suggests a harmonized pedagogy aligned with classical methods.
 - Lower/upper-sequence pedagogy references (e.g., Exordium for college advising, formal college-advising discussions) imply a structured, contemplative yet rigorous approach to learning appropriate to classical education.
 - The faculty pages and principal statements describe teachers modeling virtuous, thoughtful teaching and a love of literature, which is consistent with classical pedagogy's living-curriculum model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion, logical thinking, great works, classical content, cross-curricular approach, college advising (integrated seminars), disciplined rhetoric.
 - Negative keywords present: None evident; no explicit "project-based, experiential-only" framing undermines classical pedagogy.
- Why this rating
 - Covenant's pedagogy is squarely classical: Socratic practice, logical training, and a focus on great works, with an integrated, cross-disciplinary approach. This maps directly to Element 4's Classical indicators.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission highlights faculty modeling virtue and forming a "living curriculum," with faculty described as mentors and leaders who partner with students in learning. Principal and faculty bios emphasize teachers who integrate faith with scholarship and who discuss literature and God's truth in the classroom.
 - Faculty bios illustrate commitment to high standards, scholarship, and Christian worldview integration in teaching.
 - The Exordium and related supports underscore teachers' roles in accommodation and student development, signaling a mentoring culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: teachers as mentors, living curriculum, role models, virtue, truth, classical pedagogy, faith and reason, professional development.
 - Negative keywords present: None of the Negative Keywords appear in Covenant's public materials.
- Why this rating
 - Covenant's faculty presentation aligns with classical ideals of virtuous, mentoring teachers who model the educated life and contribute to the formation of the student. This positions Element 5

as CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Covenant emphasizes partnership with Christian families, widespread parental involvement, and a Parent Association; admissions call for families to participate and collaborate with faculty; tours and visits are encouraged. There are also explicit tuition-assistance programs and family engagement mechanisms.
 - The school's materials describe a community of grace and truth with parent involvement in life, clubs, and ceremonies; the Exordium and college-advising processes involve families.
 - The presence of a formal parent association, family-focused events, and a system to keep families engaged aligns with the classical "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" keywords.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental engagement, home-school partnership, family involvement, community, parent education through events.
 - Negative keywords present: None identified in Covenant's public materials.
 - Why this rating
 - Covenant demonstrates strong partner-with-parents and community involvement, aligning with the Element 6 Positive Keywords and expectations for classical "partnership with families" and "formation through family integration."
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What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here, since the overall classification is CLASSICAL. Covenant High School already aligns with all six classical criteria with consistent evidence across religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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